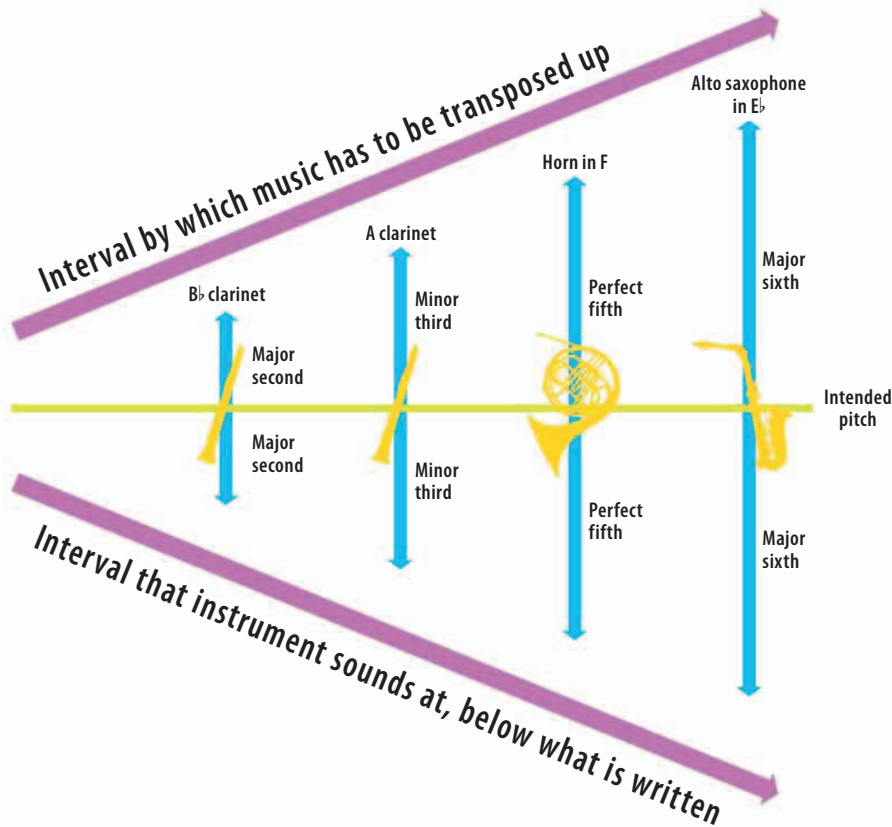




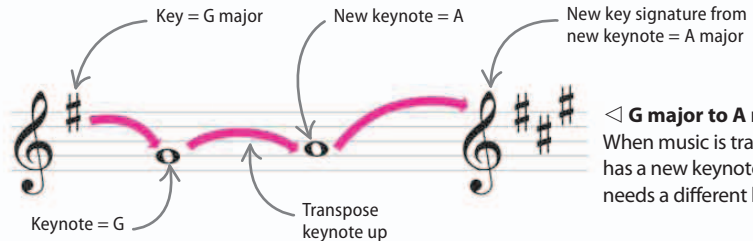
Writing music for transposing instruments

When writing music for a transposing instrument that sounds below concert pitch, the written music has to be transposed above concert pitch. The interval by which the music has to be transposed up mirrors the interval down between the written note and the note that sounds on the transposing instrument.

◁ **Intervals for transposing instruments**
Shown here are the intervals below written pitch for some of the most common transposing instruments. Music for these instruments must be written at the same interval above concert pitch.

How to transpose

The first thing to take into account when transposing is the key. For example, if you are transposing music in G major up a major second, take the keynote, G, and transpose it up a major second to A. The new keynote, A, means the transposed music is in A major.



◁ **G major to A major**
When music is transposed, it has a new keynote and, therefore, needs a different key signature.

△ Concert pitch in G major
Shown here is the opening of Mozart's *Eine kleine Nachtmusik* written at concert pitch. The note D at concert pitch is indicated.

▽ Transposed into A major
The same melody is transposed into A major, with all the notes transposed up a major second. The note D transposed up a major second to E is indicated.